Q12 Comprehension Check

Question: A colleague proposes to fix a model's missing post-cutoff knowledge by fine-tuning it on 500 recent news articles, expecting the facts to "stick." Based on this module, evaluate each of these three expectations: (a) the facts will be reliably recalled when asked about later; (b) the model's behavior on unrelated questions will be unchanged; (c) a better-performing alternative exists that does not touch the weights.

Answer: (a) Unlikely — fine-tuning on new (unseen) knowledge teaches production of that text without reliable conditions-of-application, and empirically *increases* hallucination on held-out questions (Gekhman et al. 2024). (b) Not guaranteed — fine-tuning reshapes the response distribution beyond the target facts (Q26). (c) Yes — retrieval or tool use injects post-cutoff facts into context exactly where they're needed; the module's boundary map reserves parametric memory for frequent facts and moves tail/post-cutoff questions into context.